



Dreamtime today

When Australia was colonized, the Aboriginal way of living was misunderstood and the colonials made attempts to change the way the indigenous people lived. Today, the culture is accepted and many Aborigines are returning to their traditional ways.

Uluru, or Ayers Rock as it used to be called, is the largest stone monolith on Earth.



AN ANCIENT ART

Modern painting and ancient rock art often depict the Dreamtime stories. The Rainbow Serpent is a spirit shared by many communities across Australia. It is the protector of land and people, and the source of life, but it can be destructive if it is not respected.

WALKABOUT

To enter manhood a young Aborigine will take a journey alone to prove he can survive in the wilderness in the traditional Aboriginal way. It is often referred to as a "walkabout." These boys are demonstrating a traditional way of drinking that does not disturb the water.



INITIATION CEREMONY

In some Aboriginal communities in Australia, boys have to go through an initiation ceremony to enter manhood. They are taught songs and dances, they decorate their bodies, then perform rituals that can go on for weeks.

